

Auryxia[®] (ferric citrate)



Pharmacy Coverage Policy

Effective Date: January 01, 2021

Revision Date: March 22, 2023

Review Date: March 15, 2023

Line of Business: Commercial

Policy Type: Prior Authorization

Page: 1 of 3

Humana's documents are updated regularly online. When printed, the version of this document becomes uncontrolled. Do not rely on printed copies for the most up-to date version. Refer to http://apps.humana.com/tad/tad_new/home.aspx to verify that this is the current version before utilizing.

Products Affected

Auryxia tablet

Listed Indications

[Hyperphosphatemia associated with Chronic Kidney Disease on Dialysis](#)

[Iron Deficiency Anemia in CKD](#)

Hyperphosphatemia associated with Chronic Kidney Disease on Dialysis

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member has a diagnosis of hyperphosphatemia
Criteria #2	Has chronic kidney disease
Criteria #3	Must be on dialysis
Criteria #4	Has had previous treatment, contraindication or intolerance with calcium acetate (tablet OR capsule) AND sevelamer carbonate

Approval Duration

Initial	Auryxia (ferric citrate) will be approved in plan year duration or as determined through clinical review.
---------	---

[Back to top](#)

Iron Deficiency Anemia in CKD

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member has a diagnosis of iron deficiency anemia
Criteria #2	Has chronic kidney disease
Criteria #3	Is not on dialysis

Approval Duration

Initial	Auryxia (ferric citrate) will be approved in plan year duration or as determined through clinical review.
---------	---

[Back to top](#)

Background

This is a prior authorization policy about Auryxia (ferric citrate). Refer to product labeling for complete information.

Hyperphosphatemia in dialysis patients is typically associated with increased risk for heart and bone disease. When dietary intervention is unsuccessful or no longer sufficient, pharmacological intervention becomes necessary. First line agents in CKD therapy are phosphate binders.

Auryxia (ferric citrate) is an oral, iron-based therapy for the treatment of hyperphosphatemia in CKD patients on dialysis. The KDIGO guidelines recommend lowering phosphate levels toward normal range. There is an absence of data that supports maintaining levels in the normal range.

Anemia is an important complication of CKD because it contributes to the heavy symptom burden and has a major impact on the lives of patients with CKD. Iron replacement is often effective in anemia of CKD as initial therapy and routes of administration (intravenous or oral) are determined by clinicians, patient preferences, and local available resources.

Auryxia® (ferric citrate)

Effective Date: 1/1/2021

Revision Date: 3/22/2023

Review Date: 3/15/2023

Line of Business: Commercial

Policy Type: Prior Authorization

Page: 2 of 3

Humana's documents are updated regularly online. When printed, the version of this document becomes uncontrolled. Do not rely on printed copies for the most up-to date version. Refer to http://apps.humana.com/tad/tad_new/home.aspx to verify that this is the current version before utilizing.

Auryxia (ferric citrate) is not recommended for patients with an accumulation of iron (e.g. hemochromatosis) in their body. Treatment with Ferric citrate may lead to excessive elevations in iron stores. Monitoring iron parameters such as serum ferritin and transferrin levels before and while on ferric citrate is strongly recommended. Patients may require a reduction in dose or discontinuation of IV iron.

Auryxia (ferric citrate) is an iron-based, calcium-free, oral phosphate binder.

Auryxia (ferric citrate) is indicated

- For the control of serum phosphorus levels in adult patients with chronic kidney disease on dialysis
- As iron replacement therapy for the treatment of iron deficiency anemia in adult patients with chronic kidney disease not on dialysis.

Ferric citrate binds dietary phosphate in the gastrointestinal tract where phosphate precipitates as ferric phosphate, an insoluble compound that is excreted in the stool. As a result of reduced absorption of dietary phosphate, serum phosphorus concentrations are reduced. Additionally, ferric iron is reduced to the ferrous form in the gastrointestinal tract and transported to the blood where it can then be incorporated into hemoglobin.

Ferric citrate is available as Auryxia in 210 mg oral tablets.

Provider Claim Codes

For medically billed requests, please visit www.humana.com/PAL. Select applicable Preauthorization and Notification List(s) for medical and procedural coding information.

Medical Terms

Auryxia; ferric citrate; chronic kidney disease; dialysis; CKD; end stage renal disease; hyperphosphatemia; ESRD; iron overload syndrome; hemochromatosis; iron deficiency anemia; pharmacy

Change Summary

2/27/2023	annual review // updated policy owner to CFS SME, updated background and references
-----------	---

References

1. Auryxia [Package Insert]. Cambridge, MA: Keryx Biopharmaceuticals, Inc.; Mar 2021.
2. IBM Micromedex® DRUGDEX® [database online]. Cambridge, MA: IBM Corporation: URL: <http://www.micromedexsolutions.com/>. Updated periodically.
3. KDIGO 2017 Clinical Practice Guideline Update for the Diagnosis, Evaluation, Prevention, and Treatment of Chronic Kidney Disease-Mineral and Bone Disorder (CKD-MBD). *Kidney Int Suppl* 2017;7:1-59.

Auryxia® (ferric citrate)

Effective Date: 1/1/2021

Revision Date: 3/22/2023

Review Date: 3/15/2023

Line of Business: Commercial

Policy Type: Prior Authorization

Page: 3 of 3

Humana's documents are updated regularly online. When printed, the version of this document becomes uncontrolled. Do not rely on printed copies for the most up-to date version. Refer to http://apps.humana.com/tad/tad_new/home.aspx to verify that this is the current version before utilizing.

Disclaimer

State and federal law, as well as contract language, including definitions and specific inclusions/exclusions, take precedence over clinical policy and must be considered first in determining eligibility for coverage. Coverage may also differ for our Medicare and/or Medicaid members based on any applicable Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) coverage statements including National Coverage Determinations (NCD), Local Medical Review Policies (LMRP) and/or Local Coverage Determinations. See the CMS website at <http://www.cms.hhs.gov/>. The member's health plan benefits in effect on the date services are rendered must be used. Clinical policy is not intended to pre-empt the judgment of the reviewing medical director or dictate to health care providers how to practice medicine. Health care providers are expected to exercise their medical judgment in rendering appropriate care. Clinical technology is constantly evolving, and we reserve the right to review and update this policy periodically. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted, in any shape or form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying or otherwise without permission from Humana.